Rita Davidson, PhD

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Junior organisation and management scholar with diverse research and teaching experience. Investigating occupational health from a qualitative research perspective. Current projects include the study of occupational hazards within out-of-premises work and work-related travel, cross-cultural team psychological safety and climate, and social effects on job crafting behaviours. Proficient in utilising diverse qualitative methods, including multi-sited, international, and multi-lingual ethnography, to investigate complex organizational phenomena. Skilled in coordinating and delivering lectures to large audiences, facilitating seminar discussions, administering courses, and organising impactful conferences and academic events. Recognized for academic excellence through the receipt of multiple scholarships and teaching awards, reflecting my dedication and contributions to the field.

Education

2017-2021 **PhD in Business and Management**
Alliance Manchester Business School, The University of Manchester

PhD thesis: *Organising global work travel: An ethnography of the travelling organisation*
Supervised by Prof. Damian O'Doherty and Prof. Damian Hodgson

Awarded: Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC) doctoral funding
President's Doctoral Researcher Scholarship
Alliance Manchester Business School (AMBS) doctoral funding

2016-2017 **MSc in Sociological Research** | Merit
School of Social Sciences, The University of Manchester

2013-2016 **BSc Management (Hons)** | First Class
Alliance Manchester Business School, The University of Manchester

Teaching experience

2024-currently **Lecturer**
Universidad de Santiago de Chile, Chile

- Designed, developed and delivered postgraduate modules across topics of strategy and qualitative research methods, including a 6-lecture MBA level course on strategy integrating theoretical with practical conventions, a 17-lecture course of qualitative research methods for marketing for an MSc in Marketing.
- Designed and delivered undergraduate module in strategy to penultimate year students.
- Created a curriculum, assessments, and lecture slides for the classes across undergraduate and postgraduate levels and delivered them multiple times.
- Supervised an MSc and MBA dissertation projects, leading to successful completion.
- Examined postgraduate theses, and created undergraduate final examination and examined students in the area of strategy.

Nov 2024 – Jun 2025 **Maternity leave**

2023 **Lecturer**
Universidad Diego Portales, Chile

- Developed and designed a 30-lecture module on strategy for undergraduate students in management, creating a curriculum, assessments, and lecture slides for the classes.

Aug 2022 – Feb 2023 **Postdoctoral investigator** | 6-month contract
Pontificia Universidad Católica de Valparaíso, Chile

- Designed and implemented a mentoring program for a group of 20 doctoral students, providing support and guidance in research methods and project management.

- Led a training seminar and provided personalized mentoring to enhance research and academic skills of doctoral students, fostering their professional development.

Nov 2021 – Jul 2022 **Maternity leave**

May 2021 – Dec 2021 **English coach**
Pitt English, Chile

- Utilised a pre-established programme to provide private lessons in business communication to four Spanish-speaking professionals from diverse fields, including senior executives, law, journalism, and human resources management.
- Adapted the programme according to the students' individual needs, focusing on professional and corporate language.

Sept 2019 – Feb 2020 **Lecturer**
Alliance Manchester Business School, United Kingdom

- Developed and designed a one-semester module for an undergraduate course, “Introduction to Management and Organisation Studies”, creating its content and delivering it over 10 lectures.
- Delivered engaging lectures to a large audience of 400 students, demonstrating strong public speaking and presentation skills over 20 hours of instruction.
- Supervised and led a team of 5 assistants, providing guidance and support in their teaching roles.
- Administered course, including writing and managing course assessments, moderating marks, administering contracts for teaching assistants, responding to student queries, and catering to students with special needs.

Sept 2016 – May 2021 **Seminar leader and coordinator**
Alliance Manchester Business School, United Kingdom

- Taught 3 undergraduate modules on topics of management and organisation studies, work psychology, and transformational leadership.
- Led and coordinated teams of 4 to 12 seminar leaders, ensuring cohesive teaching and delivery of a quality program.
- Mentored and guided groups of 15-20 students, leading discussions and facilitating their development and understanding of course content.
- Administered seminar programme, including marking student work, moderating marks across team of marking staff, mediated queries, corresponded with administrative personnel, and convened with teaching assistant team weekly to coordinate teaching and address outcomes and challenges.
- Efficiently resolved unforeseen issues, such as finding a replacement within a day for a team member who resigned and assumed responsibility for delivering seminars in emergency situations with short notice.
- Troubleshot and adapted rapidly to circumstances to ensure continuity and quality of the academic seminar program, such as during the start of face-to-face teaching during the pandemic, when unexpectedly a large group of students was told to self-isolate, I connected them online and ran hybrid seminars.
- Twice awarded Teaching Excellence Award.

Research experience

2024-5 **Associate professor**
Universidad de Santiago de Chile, Chile

- Integrating teaching and research in a full-time position as associate professor, including responsibilities such as administration, undergraduate and postgraduate theses supervision, grant applications, teaching at undergraduate and postgraduates levels, as well as performing research, attending international conferences, and writing academic papers.
- Leading department-level research seminars programme, including members of local faculty and national and international presenters. Aiming at the dissemination of knowledge and ideas on topics of business and management.
- Participant in SUSESO project on the management of psychosocial occupational hazards, collecting qualitative focus group data.

2023 **Research assistant**
Pontificia Universidad Católica de Valparaíso, Chile

- Assistant in a FONDECYT project on identity formation with responsibilities including conducting document search and analysis in the field of entrepreneurship, performing ethnographic research on everyday life within the project's context, and conducting interviews.

Aug 2022 – Feb 2023 **Postdoctoral investigator** | 6-month contract
Pontificia Universidad Católica de Valparaíso, Chile

- Developed and authored 2 cutting-edge research articles for internationally recognized journals, demonstrating strong analytical capabilities, effective communication of findings, and contributions to advancing knowledge in relevant fields.

Nov 2021 – Jul 2022 **Maternity leave**

Mar 2021 – Oct 2021 **Research assistant** | 8-month project
Universidad de Chile, Chile

- Collaborated closely with 2 senior academics in refining an article for a high-impact academic journal, actively contributing to the manuscript rewriting.
- Led the project revitalization by re-analysing data, proposing new theoretical frameworks, and co-authoring a new manuscript, demonstrating comprehensive involvement in product development from concept to refinement.

Industry work experience

Sept 2018 – Sept 2019 **Research Specialist**
Tetra Pak AB, Sweden

- Designed, managed, and executed a 12-month consultancy project on organizational culture, adapting to client requests and working on-site at a construction facility, showcasing the ability to work under pressure and in hazardous environments.
- Conducted extensive market research, analysing travel preferences and trends. Developed and implemented a solution plan to enhance travel practices, increasing efficiency and satisfaction.
- Utilized innovative anthropological methodologies to understand organizational culture, identify core issues, and propose comprehensive solution plans.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with engineers and managers, eliciting valuable insights through interviews and observations. Facilitated smooth communication and coordination, generating relevant data for analysing work-related travel problems.
- Travelled to 6 countries, collected data in 4 languages, and visited 3 project sites and offices, fostering interdisciplinary communication and developing multilingual and multicultural skills.
- Collaborated closely with multidisciplinary teams, including engineers, managers, and welders, to gain valuable insights and perspectives on the researched topic from diverse professional backgrounds.
- Analysed interviews, observations, and institutional documents to identify travel-related problems and propose pragmatic solutions, employing effective problem-solving techniques.
- Presented comprehensive results and recommendations to senior managers through quarterly reports and presentations, effectively communicating data-driven ideas and ensuring project success.
- Successfully completed research projects, presenting comprehensive results and recommendations through quarterly reports and presentations to senior managers, ensuring successful project outcomes.

Certifications

Dec 2021 **Associate Fellow** of Advance HE
UK-based teaching excellence higher education accreditation

Research skills

- Ethnographic methods
- Participant observation
- Qualitative interviewing, including field interviews
- Focus groups
- NVivo qualitative data analysis
- Workplace shadowing
- Archival and biographical research methods
- Narrative analysis
- Thematic analysis
- Discourse analysis
- SPSS statistics quantitative analysis

Publications

2025

- Sanfuentes, M., Valenzuela, F., & Davidson, R. (2025). Minding the gap: an analysis of hopeful, mindful organizing in the Chilean miners' underground journey from collapse to resilience, *Culture and Organization*, pp. 1–19. *https://doi.org/10.1080/14759551.2025.2551319*

Under revision:

- *The Chilling Effect: Productivity Norms and the Emergence of Psychological Safety Consensus in Latin America*, with Dr. Maximiliano Escaffi-Schwarz, Dr. Lyonel Laulié, and Dr. Mahamadou Biga, submitted to the *Journal of Managerial Psychology* with R&R decision on 16 March 2026.
- *The joys and maladies of mobile work: Understanding global work travel as ambivalence*, submitted to the *Scandinavian Journal of Management (SJR: Q1; ABS: 2)* with R&R decision on 7 July 2023.

In progress:

- *"Mitigating occupational hazards in global work travel- A job crafting perspective"* with Dr. Maximiliano Escaffi-Schwarz, to be submitted to *European Journal of Work and Organizational Psychology (SJR: Q1)*
- *"Crafting Well-being on the Road: Job Crafting Strategies for Occupational Hazards in Work-related Travel"*, to be submitted to *Journal of Management*.
- *Mobile subjectivities: Understanding mobile work as embodied*, to be submitted to *Organization Studies (SJR: Q1; ABS: 4)*

Conference presentations:

- *"Getting into Neoliberalism: An ethnographic account of mobile work"*, European Group of Organization Studies Proceedings, 2019, Edinburgh, UK
- *"'You are here': Charting, mapping, and organising mobile work"*, European Group of Organization Studies Proceedings, 2020, Hamburg, Germany
- *"Mitigating occupational hazards in global work travel- A job crafting perspective"*, European Academy of Occupational Health Psychology, 2024, Granada, Spain

- *"Crafting Well-being on the Road: Job Crafting Strategies for Occupational Hazards in Work-related Travel"*, SOCIPCO 2025, 2025, Santiago, Chile

Projects

2025 **Researcher**
SUSESO Project at *Universidad Diego Portales*, Chile

- Qualitative researcher on SUSESO project on the mitigation of occupational psychosocial risks. Responsibilities include data collection in the form of focus groups.

2023 **Research assistant**
Pontificia Universidad Católica de Valparaíso, Chile

- Assistant in a FONDECYT project on identity formation with responsibilities including conducting document search and analysis in the field of entrepreneurship, performing ethnographic research on everyday life within the project's context, and conducting interviews.

Conferences

Co-organised:

Oct 2024 **SOCIPCO 2024 Conference at USACH**

Co-organised and chaired a panel in an international day-long conference on organisational behaviour held at the University of Santiago of Chile

Apr 2021 **ESRC MethodsX Ethnography Stream event** (held virtually)

Co-organised and chaired discussions in an interdisciplinary day-long event led by and for PhD students across four universities in the North West of England

May 2020 **Ethnography Workshop Manchester** [POSTPONED to July 2022 - attended]

Co-organised and presented paper *"'You are here': Charting, mapping, and organising mobile work"*

Attended:

June 2026 **European Academy of Occupational Health Psychology** in Helsinki, Finland

Presented project *"Beyond the Individual: A Socially Embedded Model of Job Crafting"*

Dec 2025 **AOM Andes Connect Conference**

Presented paper "*Tracing the Cascade: An Organisational Ethnography of Strategy Dissemination and Meaning-Making"*

Nov 2025 **Presenter at FAE Seminar series at USACH**

Presented paper *"Crafting Well-being on the Road: Job Crafting Strategies for Occupational Hazards in Work-related Travel"*

Oct 2025 **SOCIPCO 2025 Conference at Universidad de los Andes**

Presented paper *"Crafting Well-being on the Road: Job Crafting Strategies for Occupational Hazards in Work-related Travel"*

June 2024 **European Academy of Occupational Health Psychology** in Granada, Spain

Presented project *"Mitigating occupational hazards in global work travel- A job crafting perspective"*

April 2024 **Panelist at MBA seminar series of Universidad Privada Boliviana (UPB)**

Presented research with practitioner-oriented talk on the management of travel and remote work practices, "Managing in a changing world: Organising global work travel and remote work"

Nov 2022 **PUCV luncheon Seminar – Multi-sited Ethnography**

Gave a workshop to a group of doctoral students and faculty about multi-sited and multilingual ethnography

Sept 2021 **12th PROS Symposium** (online)
Paper accepted: *"Ethnographic stories of becoming in mobile consulting work"*

Jul 2020 **European Group of Organisation Studies Conference** in Hamburg, Germany [held virtually]

- Presented paper "'*You are here': Charting, mapping, and organising mobile work*"
- Attended EGOS PhD Workshop 2020

Mar 2020 **Liverpool Crafting World-Leading Outputs from Qualitative Research Conference**
[POSTPONED due to pandemic – CANCELLED due to maternity leave]
Paper accepted: *"'You are here': Charting, mapping, and organising mobile work."*

Aug 2019 **AIDEA Capri Summer School**
Attended qualitative research methods summer school

Jul 2019 **European Group of Organisation Studies Conference** in Edinburgh, UK
Presented paper *"Getting into Neoliberalism: An ethnographic account of mobile work"*

May 2019 **Economy and Society Summer School**
Attended theory and research methods summer school

Jul 2018 **European Group of Organisation Studies Conference** in Tallinn, Estonia
Attended conference

May 2018 **Economy and Society Summer School**
Attended theory and research methods summer school

Sept 2017 **Ethnography Conference** in Manchester, UK
Attended conference

Professional affiliations

- European Academy of Occupational Health Psychology member (EAOHP)
- La Sociedad Científica Chilena de Psicología y Comportamiento Organizacional member (SOCIPCO)
- European Group of Organisation Studies member (EGOS)
- MethodsX Ethnography research stream member of the North West Social Science Doctoral Training Partnership (NWSSDTP) of the Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC)

Additional Skills

IT (proficient): Microsoft Office Suite (advanced), and SPSS Modeller and Statistics (intermediate).

Languages: English Russian Hebrew (native/bilingual proficiency)
Spanish (professional working proficiency)
Swedish (elementary proficiency)